

**UROMI JUSTICE DEVELOPMENT PEACE AND CARITAS INITIATIVES
(UROMI JDCPI)**

CORPORATE FACT SHEET

Name	Uromi Justice Development Peace & Caritas Initiatives, (Uromi JDCPI).
Owner	Catholic Diocese of Uromi, Nigeria.
Legal Holder	His Lordship, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Aimioshor Ogun (OSA)
Authorized Representative & Director	Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Oriabure Arhedo
Corporate Registration No:	CAC/IT/No: 50042 & ED/MWASD/NGOR/200/04
Status	Catholic Non-Governmental, Non-Profit making, Humanitarian and Development Organization.
Motto	Hope for the Oppressed and Empowerment for All
Areas of operation	Integral Development, Human Rights, Democracy, and Good Governance, Alternative Dispute Resolution, Prison Apostolate and Legal Aid services, Peace Building, Micro-Credit and Caritas, TB and HIV/AIDS care and support, HIV Counseling and testing, Livelihood improvement, Anti-Human trafficking and VC programming
Project steered	Conflict Management, Training of Electorate, Election Observation, Budget Monitoring, Community TB Care, HIV/AIDS Awareness Creation & Counseling, Micro-Credit Facilities, Rural Community Development Enlightenment Campaign, Prisoners' Welfare Services, Gender And Child Rights, Widowhood Association, Human Rights, Training Programmes for Police Officers and Youths, Women Development & Promotion through Micro Credit, Emergency Response, Legal Aid, VC Programming, Capacity Strengthening for Good Governance, Campaigns and Sensitizations Against Human Trafficking as well as Creating Alternatives to Human Trafficking through Vocational Skills Acquisition and Empowerment, Human Right Education and Paralegal Scheme and Don't Pay With Your Life
Focus Group	The rural populace, the economically deprived, families, children, students, youths, women and widows living among the poorest of the poor in the society. Inmates in Prison and Ex-inmates, persons stigmatized with deadly diseases.
Physical Address	Inside Uromi Diocesan Chancery at Egbele, Uromi, Edo State, Nigeria.

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Auditors	1. Grant Thornton chartered Accountants Emgn, Benin Branch 2. Edforte, Fortne, Ehiagwina & Associates 141 Benin-Auchi Road Ekpoma, Edo State
Bankers	• UBA BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • ECOBANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • FIDELITY BANK PLC Mission Road, Uromi • Unity Bank PLC Mission Road Uromi • Union Bank PLC Mission Road Uromi
Staff Strength	13
Number of Community Volunteers	65
Project Executed	16

INTRODUCTION

As part of her efforts to promote social justice, improve the knowledge of human rights of citizens, and a means to devise a more effective Alternative Dispute Resolution system, Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiative in partnership with MISEROR Germany embarked on a Human Rights Intervention across 5 Local Government Areas of Edo Central Senatorial District. Thus far executed this quarter include; gender equality sensitization bordering on Female disinheritance and women inclusion in family and societal life, 2nd Quarterly meeting of paralegals, Biannual Conference of Paralegals and Training on Justice Administration and Conflict Management for Paralegals and Human Rights Advocates.

As part of efforts to promote collaborative initiatives at strengthening security in Esan Land an eminent stakeholders forum was conveyed to address salient issues for peaceful coexistence in the senatorial district.

In a view to retain school adolescent girls in schools so that they do not get lured by human traffickers, Uromi JDPCI carried out activity to select would be beneficiaries of an intervention “DON’T PAY WITH YOUR LIFE”

In a similar line, Uromi JDPCI also intensified efforts to sensitize communities, schools, markets and churches on the need for safe migration while discouraging human trafficking and irregular migration on the platform of sustainable measures against trafficking in persons (SMAT-P). In this respect, contact was made with 699 made of 291 males and 408 females including children from amongst 2 market, 3 schools and 4 communities in 2 LGAs in Edo Central Senatorial District.

In the same vein, Uromi JDPCI provided welfare and spiritual support to the inmates in Ubiaja prison through the provision of toiletries and the offering of Holy Mass with a family

The Micro Credit desk sustained the empowerment drive with the provision of support to 1062 beneficiaries in 85 groups across communities in Edo Central Senatorial District.

GENDER EQUALITY SENSITIZATION IN FIVE LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS OF EDO CENTRAL SENATORIAL DISTRICT

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives conducted sensitization on gender equality in the five Local Government Areas of Edo Central Senatorial District. The purpose was to create awareness on the importance of gender equality in the perspective of human rights and improve knowledge and consciousness of certain laws that prohibit certain cultural and traditional practices that are inimical to the dignity of women as human being and repugnance to the law of equity and natural justice. The focus for this year was women disinheritance and inclusion in decision making at the family, community and society in general. This sensitization was held in each of the five LGAs as listed below:

1. Esan North East :Monday 19th August, 2019 at the place of the Ojuromi of Uromi
2. Esan South East :Monday 19th August, 2019 at the local government council hall, Ubiaja
3. Esan West : Wednesday 21st August, 2019 at the palace of the Onojie of Ekpoma
4. Esan Central: Thursday 22nd August, 2019 at St. Anselm Catholic Church, Irrua
5. Igueben: 23rd August, 2019 at the palace of the Onojie of Igueben

Participants for the sensitization in the respective LGAs cut across religious and community leaders, members of the human right club, political leaders, Opinion leaders, men and women as well as the youths from selected communities.

The sensitization was aimed at engaging the people to deliberate on issues of gender equality particularly on female disinheritance and women inclusion in decision making in family and societal life. It was emphasized that Uromi JDPCI has not come to impose new ideas on them or to abolish their culture but to logically discuss and seek ways to modify those cultural practices that are detrimental to the promotion of human rights as recognized in the constitution.

The discussion extensively treated issues around gender, sex, gender equality, gender roles and division of labour, female disinheritance and women inclusion in decision making, cultural perceptions that limit women involvement in social, political and economic activities in the Senatorial District.

Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo who facilitated the discussions described the term gender as a social construct which includes the rights, power and privileges given to or denied a person as a result of the sex of the person. He emphasized that gender issues are man-made, learned and can be changed. Sex on the hand was said to be biological, the distinction between the conditions of being male or female which is natural and fairly constant.

Progressively, he explained gender equality as the situation where boys and girls, male and female are given equal opportunity for participation and enjoyment of rights, responsibilities and privileges in the society devoid of any legal or cultural restrictions. Adding that equity which connotes fairness, is the thrust of equality and should be demonstrated both in the family and the society at large. He further explained that in the home, gender equality is expressed by the even distribution of roles, responsibilities and opportunities amongst family members such that no sex whether male or female should be subjected to carry out a particular activity/role or denied access to educational opportunities among others.

Still in the sensitization, issues bordering around women disinheritance were critically discussed.

The facilitator; Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo stated that situations around Esan communities is such that women are not allowed to inherit the properties of their father or that of their husband but by the male children irrespective of their position in the family. Also in cases where a woman has no male child, she loss everything to her husband's relatives and in worst scenarios is forced to leave her matrimonial home with her children; which ought not to be.

Participants were therefore exposed to relevant laws and judicial precedents that gave credence to women's right to inheritance in their fathers' and husbands houses' thus any culture or traditional that still upholds the practice of female disinheritance was considered to be acting contrary to the constitutional provisions of the state and as such, perpetrators could be sued to

court. Hence the facilitator advised that such practices should be made obsolete and expunged from the communities.

In addressing women inclusion in decision making in family and societal life, the facilitator noted that men and women are an essential resources for all nation and society. He added that many women have played key roles in the development of their family and the society, though in our cultural setting (Esan Communities), women are still relegated to the role of child bearing and house caring and are not allowed to contribute in decision making. He emphasized that husband-wife decision making is well acknowledged in all society and has been noted to bring about peace in the family and the society at large. Thus he urged men to delegate part of decision making both in the family and at community level to women because it is one of the ways of empowering the female folks. He advised that women of integrity in the communities should be made chiefs and to participate in decision making during traditional council meetings.

In conclusion the reasons for women limited participation in politics was elaborately discussed and given as follows:

- Due to the responsibility of caring for the home
- Perception of men towards women in politics
- Lack of family support
- The deceptive nature of politics and the low educational qualification of women as compared to their male counterparts.

The facilitator however opined that with the right support, the reasons given above can be well tackled to encourage participation of women in Politics.

CONTRIBUTIONS AND ISSUES RAISED IN THE RESPECTIVE LGAs

Esan North East LGA

In Esan North East, the human right supervisor; Barr Dom Okojie, in his contribution emphasized that equal opportunities to education and the actualization of potentials should be given to both male and female children

More so, he said the practice of the first son inheriting all the properties of his father without considering his other siblings as is being practiced in Esan Communities has caused disunity and



Barr. Okojie giving his contribution



Very. Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo during his presentation in Esan North East LGA.

damages to families. Although the custom of the land bestows the properties of the deceased to the first son of the family, the first son according to traditional tenets holds the property in trust on behalf of his other siblings and could not temper with the properties without the consent of his family members. But unfortunately, nowadays such tenets and values are no longer upheld in the family, hence he advised that Fathers should share their properties among their children through Will

writing.

He stated that Will writing reduces the difficulties the family of a deceased go through to recover the savings of the deceased in the bank. He added that prior to the present administration in Edo State, the government collects in advance 10% of such savings in the bank. But now, the 10% is being paid after the family of the deceased have accessed the savings.

Mr. Isaiah, a community representative from Eror asked if the purpose of the sensitization was to change or alter the headship of the male folk in the family and the society at large. He was told that the sensitization has no such purpose rather it aims at enlightening the people to realise that the girl child is not inferior to a male child as they are equal in their essence.

Elder Esene, a community representative from Ivue community thanked Uromi JDPCI for the exposure and appealed that similar sensitization should be conducted in their community (Ivue) targeting the elders of the community who uphold and implement these cultural practices.

Another participant from Eror community raised an issue that occurred in his community where elders of the community coerced a man to inherit his father's wives otherwise would be denied inheritance of his father's properties. Although the man refused to succumb to the pressures. He appealed that the sensitization should also be taken to Eror community so as to help them overcome such cultural practices.

Esan South East LGA

In Esan South East, the Local Government Chairman, Hon Victor Emuakhagbon who participated in the session with the Secretary to the Local Government, appreciated Uromi JDPCI and noted that the sensitization was a step in the right direction as cultural practices especially in Esan Land has placed the female folks in a serious jeopardy. He therefore suggested that cultural practices on inheritance should be approached in line with the provisions of the constitution and promised to give the necessary support to the actualization of that dream.



Hon Victor Emuakhagbon giving his contribution

The following questions were raised and answers were given accordingly.

- The steps that can be taken by other male children to be included in the inheritance of their fathers
- Why should fathers give inheritance to female children who would marry and stop bearing their father's name?
- Is Will writing necessary if a marriage is registered in the court

Parents were encouraged to adopt will writings as part of the strategy to avoid the first son takes all syndrome that was becoming an unfortunate trend in Esan Land. Parents were also reminded that that the female child was first human before being a woman or girl as such have much right to



Group photograph of participants in Esan South East

inheritance as the male child. Some member observed that even the male children no longer stay in the community as well because of quest for greener pasture. If the change of name was the problem then the female could be asked to retain their Fathers' name. Examples of prominent women who bears their paternal names alongside that of the husbands were given to buttress the point.

Esan West LGA

In Esan West Local Government Area, a participant commented that many a time Will written by fathers are been invalidated by community elders at the death of a deceased especially when the deceased Wills his properties to a female child in the absence of a male child.

The Human Right Supervisor for Esan West in reacting to the comment reiterated that a dully registered Will is binding on all and cannot be contested by any authority. However, a Will cannot nullify the "idiogbe" (i.e. A First son's entitlement to any landed property where his father was buried) because it is legally recognized by the Customary law.



Presentation section by Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo in Esan West LGA.

In addition, Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo emphasized that in the absence of a male child to inherit the "Idiogbe" a female child should be allowed to inherit it provided she performs the burial rights of the deceased



Group photographs in Esan West LGA.

father. He recounted that his mother inherited the idiogbe in 1984. He further gave some clue into how that can be achieved in the communities.

Esan Central, LGA

In Esan Central, a participant in her contribution advised that care and education should be given to the girl child because they care most for their parents during old age but a girl child who was not empowered through formal or informal education will have little or nothing to offer in the future. She gave an account of how her father trained her and her other female siblings despite pressures from relatives to have them neglected and abandoned. Today they are all successful and her parents are reaping the fruits of their labour. She also advised that in addition to Will writing, married men should have their spouses or children as their next of kin.

The Odionwele (community head) of Usenu commented that it is in polygamous homes that the sharing of properties usually breeds disunity among family members, adding that he has one wife and has full confidence in his first son that he would hold the properties of the family in trust on the behalf of his other siblings hence do not have a need to write a Will. He was reminded that even children from the same mother could have the same problem if their father has not taken the initiative to share things for them fairly. The concept of Will writing then became clearer to him. He admitted that he has actually shared his belongings for his children though not in written form

but by oral method with some elders as witness. The importance of Will writing was reiterated and emphasized and all fathers encouraged to write their Will

A question as to who should inherit the properties of a deceased whose wife didn't bear a child before his demise was raised.

The human right supervisor for Esan Central in response stated that the inheritance of such property is dependent on the provisions of the Will of the deceased. However in the absence of a Will the widow of the deceased should not be relegated and deprived of her rights. He further shared experiences and cases where women were denied inheritance of their fathers/husbands properties but through court preceding such was changed because such act is against the law.

He further stated that he is of the opinion that a man that has lots of properties, while he is still alive and strong should share his properties among his children, monitor their progress by calling them together at the end of every year to give an account of how they have managed such



Teaching section by Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo in Esan Central LGA.



Group photograph with participant, in Esan Central LGA.

bequeathed properties. By so doing there will be no confusion, fight and disunity in families since every child knows his property.

Igueben LGA

Contributions given include:

- Massive enlightenment in public places especially in the palace to help drive home the message
- Pamphlets and copies of the presentation should be made available to teach other people in the community
- The need for women to be proactive and serious so that they can be recognised at community levels
- The need for husband and wives to tolerate, respect and support one another in the various roles performed at home such that none is considered inferior to the other



Teaching section by Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo in Igueben LGA



Group photograph with participants in Igueben LGA

QUARTERLY MEETING OF PARALEGALS

The second Quarterly meeting of paralegals was held on the 19th of September 2019 at the chancery complex Uromi. In attendance were 62 participants made up of paralegals from the various human rights clubs and supervisors from the five Local Government Areas and the five project team. This meeting was held to review activities carried out by paralegals in their respective communities in the last quarter, note their challenges, make recommendations and share best practices for the implementation of the human rights intervention.

On the concluded training on Justice administration and conflict management, Very Rev Fr. Fidelis Arhedo commended paralegals and supervisors for their active participation during the training as he was rightly briefed, adding that the series of training they have been exposed to is intended to build their capacity so that they can function effectively and efficiently in the various roles they perform as paralegals in their respective

communities. Hence he admonished them to always take the trainings seriously and also endeavor to step down the trainings in their respective human right clubs so that members of the club can better respond to cases of human right violations within the communities. The following contributions were made by paralegals-Mr. Ikaweke Ehikioya Ernest from Emaudo community in his contribution stated that the training have been helpful as they have been able to apply knowledge gained through the training to establish an Alternative Dispute Resolution mechanisms in their community to settle disputes within the community. Mr. Christopher Idomin from Idumeka community appealed that



Opening Prayer before the quarterly



Feedback from Eguare-Ekpoma

all the training for paralegals as well as the responsibilities of paralegals should be documented in a handbook and shared amongst them.

The Executive Director in his



A section of participants during meeting

response stated that the office is jointly working with the human right club supervisors to develop a handbook for paralegals and it would be readily available soonest.

The meeting then proceeded to take report from the various paralegals across the target communities.

AKHO Human Right Club: it was reported that a step down training was conducted for human right club members in Akho, though the activity was not documented in the reporting template. They were encouraged to learn the process of documentation as it was a vita requirement from Paralegal

USENU Human Right Club: reported that step down training was done for members of the human rights club in Usenu on the 18th of August 2019. They also reported a case of a 75 years old man who tried to defile a 12 years old girl. However, the Paralegal said the girl's mother told her that the issue has been resolved and that justice was rightly served. Very Rev Fr Fidelis ARHEDO stated that the case was a human right violation as it has to do with child and sexual harassment, thus when such an issue is reported to any member of the human right club, they should report it immediately to their supervisors so that the issue can be taken up.

AGUA Human Right Club: reported that he was at the elders meeting to sensitize them on human right issues using the knowledge from the training so far conducted. One of the Paralegals noted that some of the elders were still yet to accept the reality as it concerns the position of the law on certain cultural practices. He therefore requested that the project team would have to visit the community for proper sensitization.

IDUMEBO Human Right Club: reported that there was an issue of rape in the community. The case was reported to the police station and subsequently the girl's mother withdrew the case from



Another paralegal reporting for his human right club

the police station and left with the daughter to Lagos while the alleged rapist has also left the community. Fr Fidelis ARHEDO told the paralegal to always bring such

issues to their



A Paralegal giving a report during quarterly meeting

supervisor's attention as they cannot do the work on their own. He advised that more sensitization on human right violations should be carried out and people should be encouraged to speak out and stand for their rights.

EWU Human Right Club: reported that there was a step down training for members of the human right club and sensitization was also conducted to reach out to the community members on issues of human rights violation

EGBELLE Human Right Club: reported that they conducted sensitization among women group and they are planning to invite the project team to sensitize community chiefs and elders. This they said would be necessary to let people know that they can find help if they report violations

AMEDOKHIAN Human Right Club: reported that step down training was done for members of the human rights club and sensitization on human rights was carried out in 18 quarters of the community and that the elders expressed support for the initiative.

IVUE Human Right Club: reported that creation of awareness and sensitization on human right issues have been carried out in Ivue community by members of the human rights club. He stated that the group's attention was called on a dispute involving a tenant and a landlady and they were able to resolve the conflict amicably. He also said that the elders of the community has promised to fix a date for the group to come and sensitize them, though they are yet to hear from them. Fr Fidelis Arhedo advised that they should be more proactive by meeting with the elders to arrange for a date for the sensitization rather than waiting for the elders to put a call across to them.

EFANDION Human Right Club: reported that human rights sensitization has been carried out in the community and that they hope to reach the other quarters in the community soon.

EROR Human Right Club: said that a rape case was reported to them and the perpetrator was on the run as his whereabouts was unknown, the issue has been properly documented and the Police on the issue.

EWATTO Human Right Club: reported that step down training was carried out and that they were working with the community to strengthen the already existing ADR system.

UBAIJA Human Right Club: reported that the human rights club at Ubiaja community carried out sensitization at St. Francis secondary school and at the Ubiaja police station and issues discussed during the sensitization were on cultural beliefs, dispute resolution and the establishment of human right clubs in schools. The authorities in the various institutions visited expressed firm commitment to support the intervention

AHIA Human Right Club: reported that human rights sensitization was carried out in the community. He also conveyed that a woman was fined two goats and two fowls because she touched a masquerade during a community burial which was seen as an abomination, though the woman refused to provide the items and she was told by the elders that a bigger masquerade would come and dance in her compound at night. Very Rev. Fr. Fidelis Arhedo advised that members of the human rights club should investigate issues to determine what transpired between the woman and the masquerade and that if the woman was at fault they should assist her to resolve the issues with the elders, if not report to the LGA Supervisor for further advise and action.

OKHUSEAN Human Right Club: Joel reported that community sensitization focusing on human rights issues was carried out and church sensitization was also held.

EWOHIMI Human Right Club: Peter Imhontu reported that sensitization in two quarters within the community was carried out to educate members of the community on human right and the work of paralegals in the community.

EMU Human Right Club: reported that community sensitization was conducted and the elders of the



Uromi JDPCI Executive Director in a group photograph with paralegals after quarterly meeting

community showed intention to hear from Uromi JDPCI project team.

UKHUN Human Right Club: reported that step down training on the Nigerian Legal System was done for members of the human rights club and the group also went out for sensitization on human rights and admonished the people to report cases of human rights violations to the appropriate authorities and that if they have challenges with that the human right club can assist them.

EGORO AMEDE Human Right Club: The paralegal reported that meetings were held with market women to sensitize them on the issues of human rights violations and that they also intervened to resolve potential community conflict between farmers and goat owners.

EMAUDO Human Right Club: reported that sensitization has not been carried out in the community because the community was mourning the demise of one of the community elder. But they have begun to use the knowledge gain from training to resolve disputes in their communities.

EGUARE-EKPOMA Human Right Club: reported that they intervened in the unlawful arrest of a young boy by the anti-cult unit in Police State Command, they consulted with their supervisor and after investigation the boy was proved innocent and released by the Police. They also reported that their supervisor counseled a woman that was labeled a witch and was asked to go to a shrine to drink concoction in order to prove her innocence. After the counsel, the woman picked the courage to make her decision as she was promised of legal support should she have any form of threat or undue pressure that could violate her rights.

EBELLE Human Right Club: reported that sensitization on human rights issues were conducted among women group and the council of elders in the community. He also stated that through the group's intervention a woman that was ostracized from the community and denied any form of contact with her children was pardoned as they were able to settle the issue with the council of elders. In conclusion, Very Rev Fr. Dr Fidelis Arhedo advised the paralegals on the need to pay advocacy visits to the Divisional Police Officers in their various areas to intimate them on the work carried out by paralegals in communities so as to solicit for their support. This he said should be a follow up to the advocacy paid to them by Uromi JDPCI. He also advised that they should not deviate from human right issues and should work jointly with their supervisors who are seasoned legal practitioners.

BI ANNUAL CONFERENCE OF PARALEGALS AND HUMAN RIGHTS ADVOCATE

The Human Right Education and Paralegal scheme project which is aimed at contributing towards an improved peaceful coexistence of the village community and promotion of social justice and respect for human rights has as part of its planned strategies to conduct Bi-Annual Stakeholders' Conference with a view to facilitate the establishment of a collaborative platform of instrumental stakeholder and the human rights defenders and paralegals for the defense of human rights at the grassroots. In view of this, Uromi JDPCI held its first biannual stakeholders conference on the 26th of September 2019 at Uromi Diocesan chancery complex. In attendance for the conference were Human rights supervisors, paralegals and human rights advocates across the target communities with a total of 110 persons present, comprising 61 male and 49 female.

In the opening remark, the Executive Director of Uromi JDPCI Very Rev Fr Dr. Fidelis Arhedo charged the audience to be proactive in the discharge of their responsibilities as paralegals and human rights advocate. He noted that the training they have been exposed to so far was to abreast them of their duties and obligations to vulnerable community members. He advised them to act with wisdom and respect towards community members, be it the victim or the suspect, charging



Barr Dom Okojie making contribution during meeting

them to inculcate the civil attitudes of the European law enforcement Agent and shun the barbaric attitudes of the Nigerian Security personnel's. He encouraged them to be industrious, intelligent, courageous, wise and calculative and increase the awareness of the existence of Human Rights clubs to community members. He urged them to introduce



Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo addressing participants during conference

themselves to all the Lawmakers and executioners in the community so that they can have some measure of relevance.

Thereafter the program manager; Michael Iyoriobhe made a presentation on activities carried out so far since inception of the project. The various activities carried in the course of the project, was sequentially projected and explained, starting with the Advocacy visits to Traditional rulers, Commissioner of Police as well as Area command divisions, Department of State Securities, Nigeria Federation of International Women Lawyers as well as Ministry of Justice and Nigerian Bar Association. He explained that the advocacies were done to abreast these stakeholders with the project intervention with a view of soliciting for their cooperation and collaboration. Accordingly, identification and selection of Paralegals and Human Rights Clubs members was done in twenty seven communities across the five targeted Local Government Area which was followed by the inaugural meeting of the project. Furthermore the base line assessment exercise to ascertain the level of knowledge of Human Rights in communities was done and has been fairly concluded.

Progressively, the Commemoration of the International day for the Protection of Children was celebrated on the 4th of June, 2019. He informed participants that this commemoration would be subsequently carried out every 1st of June except for unforeseen circumstances will the date be adjusted. Furthermore, he stated that two trainings have been held so far - Introduction to



A female Paralegal contributing to discussion

paralegal and human rights Advocacy and Justice Administration and conflict resolution. He explained that the



A male paralegal contributing to discussion in Bi-Annual Conference

training was to build the knowledge and capacity of paralegals and human rights advocates on Human Rights issues in order to be able to intervene where violations of Human Rights and threats of such violations are foreseen.

He also stated that gender sensitization was conducted across the 5 Local Government Area of the project intervention as part of the plan to eradicate ignorance and enhance human right knowledge in the target communities. He noted that the second phase of the sensitization which will be focusing on widowhood practices and wife inheritance will be carried out next year.

More so, the project had its first and second quarterly meetings of paralegals to promote shared learning among the various communities and the meeting provided opportunity for members to discuss and dialogue human right issues and challenges that have been encountered and how such challenges has been resolved.

He emphasized that paralegals are to facilitate monthly human rights club meetings at their various communities and most of the communities were already doing so.



The Executive Director and members in a group photograph after conference

Immediately after the activity review, participants were given opportunity to ask questions on areas they are having challenges in the discharge of their duties to allow for possible recommendation and clarifications. The following

questions consequently:



Barr Omozejie Osas making contribution to discussion

Mr. Williams asked if it was ethical to approach victims of violation of Human Right who did not lodge any complain to the human right club. Responding to this, Mr. Michael Iyoriobhe explained that it was very ethical to approach victims of Human Rights violation because many a times victims may not know who to run to for help and maybe afraid to make report. Going to them would help to boost their hope and confidence that they have persons who are behind them to ensure they get justice

Mr. Okojie Victor asked how a paralegal can tackle issues where it is perceived that a Traditional ruler and his Chiefs are biased and unjust in resolving a case. Very Rev. Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo in responding to this, explained that paralegals, advocates and club members needs to be very polite and diplomatic in expressing themselves to community members and in that vein wisely state their opinion. In addition, Barr Akhidenor informed them that Traditional rulers are not Courts of

competent Jurisdiction to finalize any matter, that where parties are dissatisfied with decisions of the traditional rulers, then the Court can be approached.

Mr. Anthony OBOH informed everyone in the meeting of how the security agents in recognizing the fact that he was an Advocate of Human Rights, through the inscription of the word “HUMAN RIGHTS ADVOCATE” on his T. Shirt, stopped the abuse he was melting on a biker (motor cyclist) on their way to the Bi annual meeting.

Conclusively Mr. Michael Iyoriobhe advised the paralegals to be law abiding in all their dealings and to spread the message to all persons.

TRAINING ON JUSTICE ADMINISTRATION AND CONFLICT MANAGEMENT FOR PARALEGALS AND HUMAN RIGHTS ADVOCATE

Uromi JDPCI in partnership with MISEROR (The catholic Bishop Conference in Germany) embarked on a Human Right Education and Paralegal scheme project to sensitize the rural populace across 25 communities in Five Local Government Areas (Esan North East, Esan South East, Esan Central, Esan West and Igueben Local Government Area) within Edo Central Senatorial District on their rights through sensitization campaigns and by engaging trained human right club volunteers and paralegals to document, report and intervene in cases of human rights violations as well as provide advice to victims of human rights violations. In meeting with objective 1 of the project- to train Human Rights Members and Paralegals to document, report and intervene in cases of Human Right violations and provide advice to Victims of Human Right violations in their environments, Uromi JDPCI organized training on justice administration and conflict management for paralegals and human rights advocates. A Total of 110 persons (69 males & 41 females) were in attendance for the training.

The program commenced with registration of participants which was followed by the setting of ground rules, eliciting of participants expectation and objectives of the training. The Information and Media Relations Officer stated that the training would focus on justice

administration and conflict resolution and thereafter took the roll call of participants from the various communities across the five LGAs of the project intervention.



Group photograph with participants after the first day of training

The Program Manager in the opening remark, charged paralegals and human rights advocate to be proactive in the discharge of their duties by reporting cases of Human Right violations to appropriate authorities. He gave a brief recap on how to fill the incident and activity Forms and encouraged them to always document activities carried out by their various groups as well as

issues reported to them or observed in the community. Additionally he said that a Whatsapp Group would be created for paralegals for quick dissemination of information.

This was followed with a presentation on the Nigeria Legal System which facilitated by Barr. Theresa ONUWABHAGBE. She gave an encapsulation of the Nigeria Legal System to mean the Law, the Courts, the Personnel of the Courts and the Administration of Justice System in the State or Country. Accordingly, she defined Law as a set of rules which regulates human conduct for the purpose of creating an orderly society. She enumerated the importance of Laws to include: the promotion of equality and freedom of citizens of a nation, the punishment of offenders or deviants, preservation of lives and properties as well as ensuring



Participant asking question for clarity during the question segment

peace and order in the society and a foundation for good governance in a state. She explained the types of Laws which are Divine Law, Man - made Law,



Mr Michael Iyoriobhe addressing participants during training

International Law, Public Law Private Law and Criminal Law.

The two forms of Laws were given as the unwritten and the written Law. Whereas Statutes and Case laws falls under the category of written Laws wherein punishments of offenders are imposed. Norms, customs and religious laws falls under the unwritten Laws wherein sanctions are imposed on deviants. Participants were asked to identify some examples of unwritten laws observed in their various communities and one such example given by a participant was that in his community, an adulterous woman is made to dance round the community naked. The facilitator emphasized that under the Nigerian Constitution, such an act was an offence against the dignity of human person.

Furthermore, the two branches of Law which includes **Criminal Laws** (which are prosecuted by the State) and **Civil Laws** (which is an individual or an interpersonal wrong) was explained with vivid illustrations and analogies.

For the purpose of clarity, questions were raised by participants during the course of the presentation. Mr. Anthony asked to know why a crime committed by a person caught in the very act is referred to as an alleged crime. Responding to the question, the Facilitator stated that until a Court of competent Jurisdiction declares an accused guilty of a crime; such a crime remains an allegation.

Another question asked by a participant was how to differentiate a Law Graduate from a Lawyer. It was explained that a Lawyer is certified and called to the Nigeria Bar whose name is written in the register of Lawyers at the Supreme Court of Nigeria. One of the Supervisors, Barr Ehizojie ORIERE informed the participants that a Law graduate could not appear in Court, nor appends his signature in a document or validate an instrument with a seal which bears the name of the Lawyer and his roll number which is usually issued by the Nigeria Bar Association.

Lastly, a participant asked why unwritten Laws which promote injustices are still being practiced in Nigeria Justice System and also asked on how to remedy the conspiracies of Law enforcement agencies with Criminals. Mr. Michael responded that unwritten laws contrary to Equity and good conscience has gradually lost ground in Nigeria, adding that unwritten laws are not actually the reasons for injustice as practiced in most communities but the manipulation of such laws is what brings about injustice. Also, in order to checkmate the incessant conspiracies of Law enforcement agents with criminals, such acts should be reported and unanimously condemned.

The facilitator explained the Hierarchies and Descriptions of the Nigeria Courts. She said that the Supreme Court of Nigeria is the apex Court with Original and Appellant jurisdictions. Followed by the Court of Appeal which is the second highest Court and whose primary function is to hear appeal from High Courts, Tribunals, or special Courts in both Criminal and Civil matters. The next, being the High Court; be it Federal or state High Courts of a State and they have concurrent jurisdiction and also



Participants paying attention to the presentation

have both Original and Appellant Jurisdictions. The National Industrial Court is a Court for Labour matters.

The Magistrate and Area Customary Courts are the inferior Courts and they have the Jurisdiction to give Judgments for matters dealing with loans, custom, tradition among others. The Juvenile Court is a special Court for hearing cases for minors and young people and tribunals are also special Courts, established for hearing specific matters such as Election Tribunals, Firearms etc.

Progressively, the personnel of Courts were explained to include the Judges and Magistrates who preside over the matters before them. The character and personality of these persons are very important because it can affect the outcome of a Case. In the high Court the Judges are addressed as my Lord whereas in the Magistrate courts, magistrates are addressed as your Worship. Another personality of the Courts is the Registrars who are responsible for administrative activities. Next are the Bailiffs whose duties include the service of Court processes and the execution of Court Orders and the Legal Practitioners are people trained to administer justice through the application of the law and the representation of parties in a matter.

A participant asked of the state of a judgment of a lower Court and its implication on a person who decides to Appeal it. Barr. Dom. OKOJIE responded that an application for a Stay of Execution is filed by the Lawyer of the party that is not satisfied with the court judgment which in effect is to put the execution of the judgment of the lower Court on hold until the determination of the matter by the Appellant Court.

Another presentation on Justice Administration in Nigeria was taken by Barr. ONUWABHAGBE Theresa. Justice Administration was explained to mean the standard of practicing Searches, Arrests and Bail applications in Nigeria. The facilitator stated that searches are done by security agencies usually with an authority to search a premises or persons known as Search Warrant while arrest is made with or without Warrant of Arrest issued by a Magistrate. She further buttressed that arrest could be made by individuals designated to do so but must immediately hand over the suspect to relevant authorities.

She enumerated the two forms of bail as Police Bail and Court Bail. Bail is free and when a suspect is arrested, he/she is expected to be charged to Court within 24hours of arrest; failure of which such suspect would be released from custody. However where a suspect is charged to Court, he/she applies for bail through his/her Legal Practitioner after which at the discretion of the Magistrate or Judge, bail would be granted for an offence not constituting Murder. She further explained that during bail process, a surety enters into recognizance on behalf of the accused before bail is perfected; in some cases self -recognizance with conditions perfects a bail process.



Cross section of Supervisors during the training

The questions below bordering on arrest and bail process were asked by the participants:

1. Whether or not Police are authorized to make arrest at night. Barr. E.C AKEWE responded that Police are authorized to make arrest at any time of the day including at night.
2. How a Paralegal should handle the demands by Police to make payments during bail process at the Police Station. It was emphasized that the human right supervisors who are legal practitioners should be consulted to deal with the Police on such matters based on the standards of the law.

The training proceeded to take some presentations on Conflict Resolution. It started with a brainstorming session wherein participants were asked of their understanding of the word conflict, why Conflict exists and how the conflicts were managed in their communities.

One of the responses given by participants was that; Conflict connotes a clash of interest and that conflict exists as a result of the following insincerity, ignorance, Disagreement between two

parties, Human difference, selfishness, intimidation, greed and lack of contentment, oppression, misunderstanding, belief, misinformation, ego/pride and self-centeredness.

The facilitator stated that conflict usually reflects the diversity and complexity of human societies and should not be seen as a dysfunctional experience, as it was an opportunity for change, adding that conflict has both positive and negative effects. Where negative effect results to loss of life and properties, malice, economic breakdown etc., positive effect leads to Justice, compromise, change, development, better understanding etc.

Moving forward, he listed and explained the different types of conflicts which were; interpersonal conflict, intrapersonal conflict, intergroup conflict, intragroup conflict, international conflict and intra national conflict. The following were explained as the ways of handling conflict: avoidance or denial, suppression or tolerance, confrontation or self -help and problem solving.

Furthermore, the mode of resolving conflicts were identified to include; negotiation, mediation, arbitration, Litigation and Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR), they were elaborately explained. Litigation was defined as matters which are handled by the Court of competent Jurisdiction whereby parties to a matter engage the services of a Legal Practitioner who appears before a Judge to decide the conflict. Whereas ADR, is the extra-judicial settling of disputes between aggrieved persons or groups. He stated that ADR is less expense, easy and faster. ADR includes Conciliation, Mediation and Arbitration.



Group Photograph for day two of the training with participants and staff of Uromi JDPCI

At the end of the presentation, a participant asked what happens in situations where mediators settle conflict in favour of one party to the dissatisfaction of the others. The facilitator advised that parties to conflicts must ensure that a person with proven intellect and integrity who is unbiased must be chosen as a mediator whose verdict could be relied upon.

In conclusion, the participants were urged to spread the impact of the training to their various communities by assisting them to establish an alternative dispute resolution mechanism to settle minor disputes and conflict within the communities. Participants expressed satisfaction and appreciation to the project team for the improved knowledge gained through the training and promised to put it to use in their operations as paralegals and human rights advocates in the various communities.

ESAN EMINENT STAKEHOLDERS MEETING HELD AT THE CHANCERY ON SATURDAY 3RD AUGUST, 2019

As part of her efforts in contributing to the growth and development of Esanland, the Diocese of Uromi in conjunction with Uromi Justice, Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives (Uromi JDPCI) convened another Eminent Stakeholders meeting to discuss pressing issues plaguing citizens of Edo Central Senatorial District. The purpose of the Eminent Stakeholders meeting was to provide a platform where regular dialogues on issues like; the menace of kidnapping, violent crimes and destruction of farmlands by killer herdsmen can be discussed with meaningful resolution on the way forward. The meeting which was conveyed by His Lordship Most Rev Dr. Donatus Ogun, the Catholic Bishop of Uromi Diocese had in attendance prominent Esan traditional leaders such as the Enijie of Uromi, Igueben, Ogwa, Orowa, Ewatto, Idoia, Urohi and Ujiogba. Some traditional Rulers such as the Enijie of Ewohimi, Opoji and Uzea also sent prominent high Chiefs to represent them at the gathering. The Member Representing Esan North



Hon. Sergius Ogun making a remarks at the event

East and Esan
South East in
the National
House of



Prof Anthony Omoregie making a contribution at the forum

Representative Hon. Sergius Ogun and the Local Government Chairman of Igueben Local Government Area were also in attendance. The Archbishop of Bendel, Anglican Communion was ably represented by Venerable Usueni and three other Clergies while Bishop Anthony Okosun was present at the event. Among other prominent civil and socio-cultural groups present were the Esan Renaissance People Vigilante, Esan Progressive Union, Lagos, Center for Esan Development Studies, Samuel Adegboyega University, Ogwa. The Catholic Episcopal Deans of the five Deaneries, Knights of St. Molumba, Diocesan Laity Council, Catholic Men Organization, Catholic Women Organization, Catholic Youth Organization were also represented at the ceremony.

In his opening remark, the Bishop of the Catholic Dioceses of Uromi, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Ogun (OSA) thanked all the Enojie and other dignitaries for honouring the invitation and expressed a deep pleasure that the resolution of the previous stakeholder's forum yielded results with noticeable changes in the attitude of citizens of Esanland. He emphasized that the need for calling for another eminent stakeholders meeting was to brainstorm on the thorny issue of

herdsmen, and their cattle destroying farms raping women, kidnapping and killing farmers who go to their farms. Bishop Ogun stressed that this menace need to be curbed as farmers were staying away from their farms which might lead to food shortages and a huge crises in the long run. He stated that he avoided mentioning names of particular ethnic groups so as not to create ethnic colouration to the crises thereby deviating from the main issue. He stated that the herdsmen were able to cause so much harm because of possible conspiracy and collaboration with some indigenes. He appealed to all participants at the event to critically analyze the situation and suggest solutions to end this crisis that is threatening the whole of Esan land and preventing Esan sons and daughters from freely accessing their home towns.

In his remark, the Honourable Member representing Esan North East and Esan South East Federal constituencies in the National Assembly, Hon Sergius Ogun expressed the need to preventing the herdsmen and cattle dealers in the community from living in isolation. He also



Onojie of Ewatto making some remarks at the event.

suggested that drones be used as surveillance on suspected hideouts of these herdsmen and further tasked the religious leaders to speak about



During the opening prayers at the event

insecurity to the congregations in their

churches. He promised to take whatever decision reached at the forum in form of a resolution to the National Assembly if requested by the stakeholders at the forum to do so.

The Chairman of Esan Renaissance People Vigilante Mr Joel Adamebor highlighted some of their contributions and efforts to improve the security situation in the five Local Government Area of Esan land. He listed funding, non-commitment from some government functionaries who have the responsibility of securing lives, inadequate support from some traditional rulers and non-consensus among the Local Government Officials on the need to support them as part of their challenges. He suggested a merger of the vigilante groups across the five Local Government Areas in Esan land for effectiveness and avoidance of the issues of jurisdiction in course of chasing criminal herdsmen from one Local Government Area to another.

The Secretary to Esan Renaissance People Vigilante further suggested that herdsmen be registered in the Local Government where they live and do business so as to ascertain the good ones from the bad ones.

His Royal Highnesses the Onojie of Ewatto and Onojie of Ogwa in their contributions at the event decried the politicization of the security situation which is tearing Esan land apart and

appealed that politics should be put aside in tackling the issue of security because it affects everyone, irrespective of political affiliation.

Some other discussant at the event presented the summary of the findings in some of their studies on the situation made the following recommendation:

1. That open grazing should not be discouraged; those that want to rear cattle should do so in a ranch. The importance of ranching in cattle business was expatiated, citing relevant examples from some countries around the world where they have conducted observatory study. They



Onojie of Iguebena making his remarks at the event

concluded that cows can actually be domesticated by anybody as against the belief that such a venture was

the



Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Ogun giving the keynote address at the event

- prerogative of a particular tribe or ethnic group.
2. A review and profiling of herdsmen in each community to allow for easy identification of intruders was further recommended. A similar situation was also recommended for cattle such that each herd of cattle belonging to a particular herdsman would have unique numbers and code to allow for tracing and identification of any invasion and destruction
 3. The issues of homage from herdsmen and foreigners with ulterior motive of requesting for land to settle should be critically considered because it promotes influx of herdsmen into such communities, thereby endangering peace and security.
 4. A review community Laws that allow herdsmen to carry arms and dangerous weapons around the communities was also recommended.
 5. The traditional, religious and political leaders were particularly admonished to ensure that there was a consensus to put politics and religion aside so as to promote the security of our people
 6. It was also recommended that a review of traditional rites and ceremonies be made to allow for the patronage of Local animals rather than cow since the meeting point between the Esan people and the Herdsmen was cow.

In conclusion, the convener of the eminent stakeholders meeting, Most Rev. Dr. Donatus Ogun thanked all the stakeholders for their contributions and appealed to the Enijie, Political and Religious leaders to support every good initiative that will advance the growth and development of Esan Land.

ANTI HUMAN TRAFFICKING DESK

DON'T PAY WITH YOUR LIFE

To end sexual exploitation and trafficking among young girls and women in Edo Central Senatorial district, Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives (JDPCI) carried out activity to select would be beneficiaries in a project tagged “Don’t Pay with Your Life. The implementation of this intervention began in the month of

July, 2019 with the identification of intending beneficiaries which was drawn from the list of the students who participated in the assessment conducted in the PACKING project. A total of 132



Household assessment in Uzebun-Okaigben

students were selected from 71 schools across the five Local Government Areas in Edo Central Senatorial District. Since the assessment for the students had already been



Household assessment in Unuwazi, Arue

conducted it was easy to draw from it the most vulnerable students for a follow up assessment of their households. The assessment commenced from Esan south East, Esan North East and Esan Central Local Government Areas simultaneously and a total of 62 households have so far been assessed within the reporting period out of which 20 most vulnerable households have been identified. This exercise was conducted to ascertain their level of vulnerability using a national tool for Household vulnerability Assessment. The aim was to retain the girl child in school through the support of the caregiver which will take the form of improving



Household assessment in Uroh

their livelihood and would then be in position to meet the school or training needs of the children thereby reducing their susceptibility to human trafficking. It could take the form of provision of business



Household assessment in Ebhoiyi

support and business

management training, direct payment to schools of beneficiaries to meeting their educational needs.

In this reporting period Household vulnerability assessment was concluded for 62 out of the 75 identified beneficiaries in three Local Government Areas (Esan North East, Esan South East and Esan Central LGAs). The project team intend to mop up the remaining 13 intending beneficiaries

in the three Local Government Areas before the end of September and then move to the other two Local Government Areas where about 57 intending beneficiaries have also been identified for assessment from the Data base of the PACKING project, using the level of vulnerable among the already sensitized in-school adolescents in 69 Government Secondary Schools in Edo Central Senatorial District.

The household assessment were conducted in the homes of the various beneficiaries. For ease of identification and location of the places of residence of the beneficiaries, the project team went to the schools of the beneficiaries, sought the approval of the school authorities to allow the various students take the project team to their homes for assessment.

SUSTAINABLE MEASURE AGAINST TRAFFICKING IN PERSONS (SMAT-P)

COMMUNITY SENSITISATION

In a bid to curb Human Trafficking and Irregular Migration, Uromi JDPCI project team visited five communities and two markets for sensitization on Human Trafficking; the purpose of which was to create awareness on the ills of human trafficking and irregular migration. The communities visited were Idi-ozigono and Agesan in Illushi and Ikekhen and



Sensitization at Agesan Illushi

Eguare in Ewohimi in Esan South East LGA while Ukpeko-Osoikhia community, Opoji and Usugbenu markets

were visited in Esan Central LGA. The team spoke on the dangers of human trafficking and the risk it poses to the lives of young persons, their families and the community in general. The team

explained that a lot of the people who are carried through irregular routes ends up in bondage and then become victims of human trafficking. It was noted that victims of human trafficking were exposed to untold hardship,



Sensitization at Eguare Ewohimi

exploitation and dehumanizing circumstances. The parents were encouraged to desist from pressuring their children to go abroad and to stop selling properties to send their children abroad especially when they do

not have any form of skills,



Some participants during the sensitization



A women from the community corroborating sensitization message

necessary requirement, or specific business to conduct abroad. It was said that travelling abroad was not a bad thing but doing so without relevant information, necessary requirements or through irregular means was dangerous as it can make them fall prey to human traffickers. The team thereafter showed a documentary titled “Libya Journey to hell” and another in which a victim of trafficking was narrating her ordeal to the community which they watched with interest.



Cross section of the community people watching the documentary

The Participants in the communities thanked the team for the enlightenment and some of them who have been affected explained to others the pains and encouraged them to raise their children on their own and avoid sending them out to be used as house helps despite their economic situation. They further encouraged the young women to send their children to school so that when they become successful, they can be source of happiness to them and the community at large.

were reached.

A total of 456 persons made up of 170 males and 286 females

SENSITISATION IN OPOJI AND USUGBENU MARKETS



Market people watching the documentary

In the same vein, Uromi JDPCI project team was at Opoji and Usugbenu markets in Esan Central LGA to sensitize the market women on the ills of human trafficking. The habit of selling family possession or

property to send a child abroad was condemned while women were

asked to desist from pressuring their daughters into inglorious acts that were capable of making them end up in the hand of human traffickers or Irregular Migration.



Staff speaking to the market people



At the sensitization scene

The team then proceeded to show documentary of the dangers of human trafficking and documentary of the experiences of people who have gone through the agony and torture of human trafficking. Some women

expressed shock as the victim



Market people still watching the documentary

spoke of their ordeal in the hands of traffickers. Some women requested for routine visit to the market by team to constantly refresh the minds of the people as well as enable the information to be well disseminated in the market and community at large. A woman lamented that her sister's son went to Libya through irregular means and that since then they have not heard from him. She pleaded that we should help them tell government to bring them back as their mothers were not happy they are there.

SCHOOL SENSITIZATION

Uromi Justice Development Peace and Caritas Initiatives in a bid to sustain the campaign against the menace of human trafficking and irregular Migration visited 3 schools in Esan Central Local Government Area to sensitize the students on the ills of Human Trafficking and Irregular Migration. During the sensitization the team explained to the students what human trafficking entails as means of exploitation as well as its effects in the life of the victims. They were admonished not to be deceived by the



Sensitization at Mother of Nation Primary School



Sensitization at Akho primary school

glossary attraction from friends and

relatives whose means of livelihood cannot be ascertained or explained beyond going abroad or having relatives abroad. Some ugly situations experienced by victims of human trafficking and irregular migration were explained to the students, after which they were shown a documentary of the experiences of victims of human trafficking and another on the dangers migrants face in passing through irregular routes, the desert and the Mediterranean Sea. The

students also saw the experiences of persons who have travelled and their ordeal in transit countries such as Libya. Among the schools visited were Mother of Nation Primary School, Akho Primary School and Usugbenu Primary. At the end of the sensitization in each school, the students were encouraged to report any attempt to lure them to NAPTIP or Uromi JDPCI. They also asked questions to clarify their doubts on what they watched and heard during the sensitization exercise. A total of 243 students were reached comprising of 121 males and 122 females.



Sensitization at Usugbenu primary school

VICTIM SUPPORT GROUP

As part of efforts to promote reintegration and psychosocial



**Support group meeting in Ewohimi
Esan South East LGA**

support for victims of human trafficking and returned migrants Uromi JDPCI supported the formation and meetings of two victims support groups (one in Esan Central and one in Esan South East LGA). The victims support groups started their routine meetings with a review of previous meeting's discussion and thereafter



**Support group meeting in Ewohimi
Esan South East LGA**

resolved to pay courtesy visit to some prominent members of their community to introduce themselves for possible consideration in any future social intervention in the community or Local Government Area and among those identified were the Local Government Chairmen in both LGAs. The group was then encouraged to draw a schedule of how they intend to conduct the visit and let the project team know if they would want to be accompanied.

In Esan Central the group developed a slogan “Great Returnees - Hope again” and also reminded themselves of their discussions to printing of identity cards, T-shirts and letter head paper to enable



**Some members during meeting in
Esan Central**

them visible in their LGA. The president thereafter presented a proposed logo which was discussed and accepted by all the members. They noted that the hand in the Logo signifies unity and a pointer to the right direction. They were then told to sketch the logo out for clarity and



**Some members during meeting in
Esan Central**

bring to the next meeting.

They were also advised to pen down their skills and share out to members for the sake of connectivity and linkages.

VALIDATION AND PLACEMENT FOR EDUCATIONAL SUPPORT

Uromi JDPCI project team led by the executive director Very Rev Fr Dr. Fidelis Arhedo went round the various schools to assess the selected beneficiaries educational needs and requirement using the template provided. The school Principals gave a list of the basic requirements and appreciated the project for the initiatives which they said was direly needed to sustain the



Fr with Principal during placement

vulnerable students in school. The Principals also assisted with the validation of the list and placement of the students in their appropriate classes. In Irrua Girls Secondary School it was discovered that two of the students whose names were



Fr with Another Principal during placement

earlier submitted have been given scholarship by another group. These students were congratulated and replaced by other students from the Principal's list earlier submitted to Uromi JDPCI. This replacement was done with inputs from the school authorities. A total of 70 beneficiaries made up of 41 males and 29 females were validated in 6 schools.

TRAINING ON INCOME GENERATING ACTIVITIES, RECORD KEEPING, MANAGEMENT AND MARKETING IN ESAN SOUTH EAST AND ESAN CENTRAL LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS

Uromi JDPCI conducted a step down training on income generating activities for selected beneficiaries in two Local Government Areas (Esan South East and Esan Central) with 50 women trained in each of the two LGAs. The objective of the training was to equip selected beneficiaries with the knowledge of how to use book keeping, management and marketing principles to run a viable business and how they

can identify business/ market opportunities within and outside their environment.



Facilitator making a demonstration for the people

The facilitator took participants through some topics such as Record keeping, its importance and how it can help improve business. It was further emphasized that customers are the most important people to a business because without customers there will be no sales and business will have to close down. Customers were identified to include:

- The people who buy from us now
- The people we hope will buy from us in the future and

- The people who stopped buying from us but we hope to bring back

The importance of customer satisfaction was also emphasized and the following points to be noted for customer satisfaction

- Know what products or services to provide
- Know what prices to charge customer
- Know how and where to reach customers
- Know how to attract customers to buy through promotion and
- Deliver consistent and quality products and standard services.



A participant responding to questions during training Esan South East LGA

This was further illustrated using the marketing mix popularly known as the 7Ps- Product, Price, Place, People, Promotion, Processes and Physical Evidence.

The third presentation was on Market Opportunity Identification. This was defined as identifying market opportunities in an area. The Facilitator explained that problems/needs of a community can yield business opportunities and business opportunities can be identified by noting:

- What people are complaining about?
- What people are currently doing that could be done in better ways
- Generating ideas to solve the problem
- Taking actions

In conclusion, participants were urged to have positive expectations for their businesses and allow such positive expectations to motivate them at all time because being motivated by the right reasons is strength. More so, they should be committed and be willing to put business before almost everything else, loose time with friends and social events so that they can continue to remain in business. A total of 100 beneficiaries, 2 SILC agents and 10 frontline advocates were present for the IGAs training in Esan South East and Esan Central Local Government Area (56 in Esan South East and 56 in Esan Central)



Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo addressing beneficiaries in Esan Central LGA

MICRO CREDIT

Empowerment of the less privileged in the society has always been one of the major policy thrust of Uromi JDPCI. For this reason the Micro credit scheme was established to provide soft loans for enterprise development. These soft loans are always given to groups as well as registered cooperative society. Each group consists of poor, active women and active farmers in the society. This scheme is open to Catholics and Non-Catholics within the Diocese of Uromi. The scheme is currently supporting a total of 1080 persons in all the five Local Government Areas covered by the Catholic Diocese of Uromi.



Micro credit Officer with beneficiary

The scheme is in four (4) platforms namely: Group Micro-Credit, PROMIC I, PROMIC II and AGRIC PROMIC (for farmers only). It is a basic requirement that beneficiaries form themselves into self-selected group before they are considered for assessment and training. Upon successful registration, validation and documentations, the members of the group then qualify to get soft loan which must be disbursed to them through their bank accounts.

The Agricultural scheme was introduced to enhance the production and livelihood opportunity of the farmers. The scheme is designed to address the plight of the rural farmers to help increase their agricultural productivity and also for active farmers who wish to move from subsistence farming to small scale commercial farming.



Cross section of micro credit officer and beneficiaries of precious cooperative during refresher training at Obeidu 1

In this quarter a total of 4 groups with 49 members were supported to improve their businesses including

farming business across communities in Edo Central



Cross section of micro credit officers and beneficiaries of Onosetale group during collection

Senatorial District. Monitoring visits to the various groups showed that the beneficiaries have gainfully invested their soft loans in their businesses and farms in line with the objectives of the scheme

Uromi JDPCI appreciated the various groups for their solidarity and urged them to co-operate with the organization and show more commitment to repayment that could possibly qualify them for another round of loan. The various groups led by their group leaders thanked Uromi JDPCI for their support and promised to improve on their members' commitment, and pleaded for increase of the soft loan as things were becoming very expensive.

PRISON APOTILATE

WELFARE SERVICES

As part of efforts to support welfare and hygiene of inmates in Ubiaja Prison, Uromi JDPCI with support from some Parishes provided some basic necessities to the prison for the services of inmates. The Welfare Officer who appealed to Uromi JDPCI for assistance also received the items on behalf Ubiaja Prison. The items which were presented on the 27th of September include 6 rolls of tissue paper, 288 bathing soaps, 288 washing soap and 280 toothpaste.



Prison welfare officer accepting the items from the Legal officer of Uromi JDPCI

In the same vein Uromi JDPCI accompanied the family of Sir and Lady D.K Iyere to celebrate with the inmates at the Ubiaja Prison. The ceremony which began with the Holy Mass had in attendance Very Rev Fr Dr. Fidelis Arhedo, friends and family members of Sir and Lady D.K Iyere.



The family of Mr D.K. Iyere with Fr Fidelis Arhedo , Prison welfare officer with the food items and drinks for the celebration

Very Rev Fr Dr. Fidelis Arhedo who gave the homily emphasized the importance of the message of Transfiguration to the Catholic Church because of the manifestation of the Glory of God at the event. He admonished the inmates to seek repentance and put their trust in God as He was able to save and deliver through the manifestation of His Glory. He noted that if the people would repent and strive for peace and righteousness they will see the manifestation of God's glory and that all what was required to achieve this is faith and trust in the name of Jesus.

The celebrants appreciated the Prison Officials for the good work at reforming the inmates and urged the inmates to see their imprisonment as opportunity for reformation rather than as punishment. The Prison Welfare Officer thanked the family for their generosity and also used the occasion to appreciate the continuous support of the Catholic Church through Uromi JDPCI. The family thereafter shared food and drinks with the inmates.

SKILL ACQUISITION CENTER AT THE PRISON

Uromi JDPCI also supported the prison's skill acquisition center with two super tapper clips to assist them to keep their hair tidy and support those who want to acquire barbing skills to do so. The sets of clippers were handed over to the Officer in Charge and the



Very Rev Fr Dr Fidelis Arhedo donating clippers to skills acquisition centre

Welfare Officer of the Ubiaja Prison by Very Rev Fr. Dr. Fidelis Arhedo.